

A Visit to a Historical Place

A historical place refers to a location or site that holds significant historical importance due to its cultural, social, political, or architectural relevance. These places often have a connection to significant events, notable figures, or specific time periods in history. Historical places are preserved and protected to showcase their historical value and educate visitors about the past.

Man is never satisfied with what he has known and seen. He wants to know more and more. Exploration is one of the best ways to learn. Thus, he wants to get the flavor of the historical places. So as a student I have a keen interest to know the historical places of my country. It is my spontaneous habit to visit the historical places of our country whenever I get time and chance because it gives me much pleasure. During the last autumn vacation, I got such an opportunity to visit Bagerhat, a place of great historical importance.

In Bangladesh, there are some historical places. They are now regarded/declared as the World Heritage Sites. The Sundarbans, Mahastangarh, Kuakata, the Buddhist Vihara at Paharpur, Sonargoan, Bagerhat etc. are the places of historical importance. Each place has its specialty and importance

Bagerhat is a great historical place. Hazrat Khan Jahan Ali founded this town. He was a just ruler and great saint of the fifteen century. At the time of his reign, Bagerhat was a part of the Sunderbans. He built many official buildings to run his administration. He also built many mosques and dug tanks. The buildings erected by him are now all in ruins. When I saw these historical buildings, my joys knew no bounds.

The Mazar of Khan Jahan Ali is a fine one-storeyed building. It has a beautiful dome. Hazrat Khan Jahan Ali was buried there. The tomb is made of cut out stones. It cannot be accurately said from where these were brought. It is said that Pir Khan Jahan Ali brought these from Chittagong by floating on water. On the tomb, there are inscriptions in Arabic. An inscription says that he died on 25th October 1459. There is a small mosque nearby. A close associate of Khan Jahah Ali was buried outside the tomb. On the night of the full moon in the month of Chaitra, a big fair is held beside the Mazar. Many people from different parts of this country visit the fair.

There is a big tank in front of the Mazar. The local people call it the Dighi of Khan Jahan Ali. There are some crocodiles in this big tank. They come near when the Fakirs call them and give them something to eat. I saw the Dighi with my own eyes and got much pleasure.

I also visited the Shatgambuj Mosque. It is an Islamic edifice. It is a big and beautiful building. It is still in a good condition. It stands on sixty stone pillars with its seventy-seven domes. They are made of stones. The mosque is beautifully decorated. It is said that it was used as a mosque by Pir Khan Jahan. Besides being used as a prayer hall the mosque was also used as the court of Khan Jahan Ali.

Khan Jahan Ali adorned the city of Bagerhat with numerous mosques, tanks, roads, and public buildings. The interior and exterior of the mosque give a view of rather plain architecture but the interior western wall of the mosque was beautifully decorated with terracotta, flowers and foliage. The mosque has a great attraction for the tourists and visitors

There is a big dighi near the Shatgambuj Mosque. This dighi is called the Ghora Dighi. It is said that a horse was made to run before digging the Dighi. The horse ran straight and stood covering a certain distance. That distance was accepted as the length of the Dighi. That is why the Dighi is called Ghora Dighi. I visited this Dighi and came to know many things about the social works and reformations of Khan Jahan Ali.

Bagerhat is really a place of historical interest. I spent eight hours there and saw many historical things and enjoyed them very much. Now it is one of the World Heritage Sites. It was indeed a rewarding visit. The sweet memory of this visit will remain ever fresh in my mind.